Pupil Name: _____ **Class:** _____

Superpower Relations and the Cold War, 1941–1991

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY • PAPER 2: PERIOD STUDY (OPTION P4) • MASTER KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION



COGNITIVE SCIENCE **WHY RETRIEVAL PRACTICE WORKS • OVERCOMING THE FORGETTING CURVE**

Human memory decays exponentially after learning—a reality proven by Hermann Ebbinghaus's *Forgetting Curve*. While passive re-reading creates a deceptive illusion of mastery, **deliberate retrieval practice** actively reconstructs neural pathways, arresting forgetfulness and cementing essential historical knowledge into long-term schema.

Archival Plate: *Source A: Jubilant citizens atop the Berlin Wall in front of the Brandenburg Gate following the opening of border crossings (10 November 1989). German Federal Archives (Bundesarchiv Bild 183-1989-1110-018).*

SPECIFICATION REFERENCE & HISTORICAL FOCUS	HW DUE DATE	1. SOLO (WRITTEN)	2. PARTNER (VERBAL)	PARENT / TEACHER SIGN
KT 1.1: The Grand Alliance & Wartime Conferences (1943–1945) Tehran (1943), Yalta (Feb 1945), Potsdam (Jul 1945), ideological rivalry & attitudes of Big Three	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 1.2: Atomic Monopoly, Telegrams & Satellite States (1945–1947) Hiroshima & Nagasaki, Kennan's Long Telegram, Novikov Telegram, Churchill's Iron Curtain & Soviet satellites	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 1.3: Containment: Truman Doctrine & Marshall Plan (1947–1949) Truman Doctrine ($400m), Greece & Turkey, Marshall Plan ($13.7bn), Cominform (1947) & Comecon (1949)	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 1.4: The Berlin Crisis, Division of Germany & Military Pacts (1948–1955) Bizonia, Deutschmark, Berlin Blockade (Jun 1948–May 1949), Berlin Airlift, FRG, GDR, NATO & Warsaw Pact	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 2.1: The Nuclear Arms Race & The Hungarian Uprising (1949–1956) Soviet A-bomb (1949), H-bomb (1952/53), ICBMs, Khrushchev's Secret Speech, Imre Nagy & Soviet tanks in Budapest	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 2.2: The Berlin Refugee Crisis & The Berlin Wall (1958–1961) Brain Drain, Khrushchev's 1958 Ultimatum, Geneva/Camp David/Paris/Vienna summits, U-2 Crisis & 13 August 1961	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 2.3: The Cuban Revolution & The Cuban Missile Crisis (1959–1962) Fidel Castro, nationalisation, Bay of Pigs (Apr 1961), U-2 discovery (Oct 1962), naval blockade & 13 Days	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 2.4: Crisis Aftermath & The Prague Spring (1963–1968) Moscow-Washington Hotline, Test Ban Treaty (1963), Non-Proliferation (1968), Alexander Dubcek & Brezhnev Doctrine	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 3.1: The Era of Détente: SALT 1 & Helsinki Accords (1969–1975) Détente, Richard Nixon, Leonid Brezhnev, SALT 1 (1972), Apollo-Soyuz (1975) & Helsinki Three Baskets	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 3.2: The Breakdown of Détente & Invasion of Afghanistan (1979–1980) Soviet invasion (Dec 1979), Hafizullah Amin, Babrak Karmal, Carter Doctrine, Moscow (1980) & LA (1984) boycotts	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 3.3: The "Second Cold War" & Ronald Reagan (1981–1985) Ronald Reagan, "Evil Empire" speech (1983), defense spending surge, SDI ("Star Wars") & Soviet economic strain	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____
KT 3.4: Gorbachev, Fall of the Wall & Collapse of the USSR (1985–1991) Glasnost, Perestroika, INF Treaty (1987), Sinatra Doctrine, 9 Nov 1989, Malta Summit & Dissolution of USSR	_____	____ / 16	____ / 16	_____

HOW TO COMPLETE YOUR RETRIEVAL CYCLES:

1. SOLO (WRITTEN): Complete each 8-question enquiry from memory in test conditions. Every question requires a precise **Core Fact** and **Historical Explanation**. Self-mark and correct in green pen using the Department Answer Bank (pp. 14–16).

2. PARTNER (VERBAL): Hand your booklet to a **parent, carer, family member, or study buddy** to test you out loud from the Answer Bank until you achieve 16/16 mastery!

KT 1.1: The Grand Alliance & Wartime Conferences (1943–1945)

Key Enquiry Question: "Why did the wartime Grand Alliance collapse into mutual suspicion at Yalta and Potsdam (1943–1945)?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

- **Nov 1943** Tehran Conference (Seco... →
- **Feb 1945** Yalta Conference (4 Zone... →
- **12 Apr 1945** Roosevelt Dies; Truman P... →
- **16 Jul 1945** US Trinity Atomic Test →
- **Jul 1945** Potsdam Conference (Cla...

Q1 Which three nations and leaders formed the "Grand Alliance" during the Second World War? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 At the Tehran Conference (November 1943), what military commitment did Britain and the USA make to Stalin? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 At the Yalta Conference (February 1945), into how many military zones was defeated Germany to be divided? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 What international peacekeeping organisation did the Big Three agree to establish at Yalta in 1945? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 What political pledge did Stalin make at Yalta regarding the liberated nations of Eastern Europe? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 Which new US President represented America at the Potsdam Conference in July 1945? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 What secret military breakthrough did President Truman deliberately reveal to Stalin during Potsdam in 1945? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 How did the Big Three resolve disagreements over German reparations at the 1945 Potsdam Conference? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Conflating decisions made at Yalta with Potsdam. At Yalta (Feb 1945) the Big Three agreed to divide Germany into four zones; at Potsdam (Jul 1945) Truman and Attlee clashed bitterly with Stalin over Polish borders and German reparations.

KT 1.2: Atomic Monopoly, Telegrams & Satellite States (1945–1947)

Key Enquiry Question: "How did Soviet expansion and the creation of satellite states divide Europe behind an Iron Curtain (1945–1948)?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

- **1945** Red Army Occupies Easte... →
- **Feb 1946** Kennan's Long Telegram →
- **Mar 1946** Churchill's Iron Curtain S... →
- **Sep 1947** Cominform Established →
- **Feb 1948** Czech Communist Coup

Q1 On which two Japanese cities did the United States drop atomic bombs in August 1945? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 In February 1946, what secret 8,000-word cable did US diplomat George Kennan send from Moscow? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 In September 1946, what Soviet diplomatic telegram reported that the USA was pursuing world domination? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 In March 1946, what famous phrase did Winston Churchill use at Fulton, Missouri to describe the division of Europe? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 What term describes Eastern European nations officially independent but strictly controlled by Moscow? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 What political technique did communist parties use to eliminate political opponents in Eastern Europe? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 In which Eastern European country did communists stage a violent coup d'état in February 1948? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 Why did Stalin consider control over Poland essential to Soviet national security after 1945? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Forgetting the reciprocal impact of the 1946 telegrams. Kennan's Long Telegram convinced the US that Stalin sought world conquest; Novikov's Telegram convinced Moscow that the US was preparing for global war.

KT 1.3: Containment: Truman Doctrine & Marshall Plan (1947–1949)

Key Enquiry Question: "How did the Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan establish the American policy of containment (1947–1949)?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

Mar 1947 Truman Doctrine Announ... → Jun 1947 Marshall Plan Announced → Jan 1948 Bizonia Formed → Jan 1949 Comecon Founded → Apr 1949 NATO Alliance Formed

Q1 In March 1947, which speech marked the official departure of the USA from traditional peacetime isolationism? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 Which two Mediterranean nations received $400 million in urgent US military aid under the Truman Doctrine in 1947? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 What foreign policy strategy became the central foundation of American Cold War strategy following 1947? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 In June 1947, what massive economic recovery package for war-torn Europe was proposed by George Marshall? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 What economic motive underpinned the Marshall Plan alongside the political goal of stopping communism? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 How did Stalin dismiss and condemn the Marshall Plan in Soviet propaganda? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 What organisation did Stalin establish in September 1947 to coordinate European communist parties? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 In January 1949, what economic alliance did the USSR establish for its Eastern European satellite states? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Describing the Marshall Plan as simple charity. It was a strategic economic weapon designed to rebuild European capitalism and eliminate the poverty where communism flourished, while Cominform coordinated anti-Western propaganda.

KT 1.4: The Berlin Crisis, Division of Germany & Military Pacts (1948–1955)

Key Enquiry Question: "Why did the Berlin Crisis of 1948–1949 lead to the permanent division of Germany and the creation of NATO?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

Jun 1948 Deutschmark Introduced → **24 Jun 1948** Stalin Begins Berlin Block... → **26 Jun 1948** Berlin Airlift Commences → **12 May 1949** Berlin Blockade Lifted → **May–Oct 49** FRG & GDR Established

Q1 In January 1947, which two Western occupation zones merged economically to form "Bizonia"? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 In June 1948, what economic reform in Western Germany triggered Stalin's decision to blockade West Berlin? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 On 24 June 1948, what action did Stalin take to force Western powers out of West Berlin? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 What military operation did Western allies launch to keep West Berlin supplied without starting a shooting war? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 For how many months did the Berlin Airlift operate before Stalin admitted defeat and lifted the blockade? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 In May 1949, what official state was established in the Western zones of Germany? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 In October 1949, what state was established by the Soviet Union in its eastern occupation zone? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 In April 1949, what collective defense military alliance was founded by the USA and 11 Western nations? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Confusing the 1948–49 Berlin Blockade with the 1961 Berlin Wall. In 1948, Stalin cut road, rail, and canal routes to starve West Berlin, prompting the 11-month Allied Airlift; no wall existed in 1948.

KT 2.1: The Nuclear Arms Race & The Hungarian Uprising (1949–1956)

Key Enquiry Question: "How did the nuclear arms race and the Warsaw Pact intensify Cold War rivalry (1949–1958)?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE | Aug 1949 Soviet Atomic Bomb Test → Nov 1952 US Detonates Hydrogen B... → May 1955 Warsaw Pact Created → Feb 1956 Khrushchev Secret Speech → Nov 1956 Hungarian Uprising Crus...

Q1 In August 1949, what event ended the United States' four-year monopoly on nuclear weapons? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 In November 1952, what catastrophic new weapon, 1,000 times more powerful than the Hiroshima bomb, did the US test? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 What new delivery vehicle developed in 1957 allowed nuclear warheads to strike enemy territory within 30 minutes? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 In February 1956, what speech by new Soviet leader Nikita Khrushchev signaled the policy of "De-Stalinisation"? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 Which despised, hardline Stalinist leader of Hungary was forced to resign in July 1956? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 Who was appointed Prime Minister of Hungary in October 1956 to restore calm following student riots? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 What fatal announcement by Imre Nagy on 1 November 1956 triggered the massive Soviet military invasion? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 On 4 November 1956, what military force did Khrushchev dispatch into Budapest to crush the Hungarian revolution? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Believing the USA intervened to help Hungary. Despite radio broadcasts encouraging rebellion (Radio Free Europe), the West sent zero troops to Budapest because Hungary lay inside the acknowledged Soviet sphere of influence.

KT 2.2: The Berlin Refugee Crisis & The Berlin Wall (1958–1961)

Key Enquiry Question: "Why did the Soviet Union violently suppress the Hungarian Uprising in 1956?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

Nov 1958 Berlin Ultimatum (6 Mont... → **May 1960** U-2 Spy Plane Shot Down → **Jun 1961** Vienna Summit Clashes → **13 Aug 1961** Berlin Wall Erected → **Jun 1963** Kennedy "Ich bin ein Berli...

Q1 Between 1949 and 1961, approximately how many citizens fled communist East Germany through West Berlin? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 In November 1958, what ultimatum did Nikita Khrushchev issue to the Western powers concerning Berlin? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 Which September 1959 summit between Eisenhower and Khrushchev established a temporary thaw in Cold War tensions? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 In May 1960, what espionage incident shattered the Paris Peace Summit before formal negotiations began? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 At the Vienna Summit in June 1961, how did Khrushchev attempt to exploit newly elected US President John F. Kennedy? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 On what date did East German troops begin unrolling barbed wire along the border to seal off West Berlin? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 What iconic military standoff occurred in October 1961 when US and Soviet tanks faced each other at 100 yards? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 In June 1963, what historic German phrase did President Kennedy speak to a crowd of 450,000 West Berliners? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Assuming the Berlin Wall was built by the Western Allies. It was built by communist East Germany (with Khrushchev's blessing) to imprison its own citizens and stop skilled workers escaping into democratic West Berlin.

KT 2.3: The Cuban Revolution & The Cuban Missile Crisis (1959–1962)

Key Enquiry Question: "Why did Khrushchev order the construction of the Berlin Wall in August 1961?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

Jan 1959 Castro's Cuban Revolution → Apr 1961 Bay of Pigs Invasion Fails → 14 Oct 1962 U-2 Spots Soviet Missiles → 22 Oct 1962 Kennedy Declares Quara... → 28 Oct 1962 Missiles Withdrawn from ...

Q1 In January 1959, which revolutionary leader overthrew the US-backed Cuban dictator Fulgencio Batista? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 Which superpower stepped in to buy Cuban sugar and provide economic and military aid to Castro in 1960? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 In April 1961, what disastrous CIA-backed invasion by 1,400 Cuban exiles attempted to overthrow Castro? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 Why did Nikita Khrushchev secretly decide to place nuclear ballistic missiles in Cuba in summer 1962? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 On 14 October 1962, what photographic evidence discovered by a US U-2 spy plane triggered the Cuban Missile Crisis? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 What special advisory body of 12 politicians and military commanders did Kennedy create to manage the crisis? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 Why did President Kennedy deliberately describe his naval blockade of Cuba on 22 October 1962 as a "quarantine"? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 On 27 October 1962 ("Black Saturday"), what dangerous incident brought the superpowers to the verge of war? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Forgetting the secret concession in the Cuba resolution. Publicly, Khrushchev withdrew missiles in exchange for a US pledge not to invade Cuba; secretly, Kennedy also agreed to remove US Jupiter missiles from Turkey.

KT 2.4: Crisis Aftermath & The Prague Spring (1963–1968)

Key Enquiry Question: "How close did the Cuban Missile Crisis of October 1962 bring the superpowers to the brink of nuclear war?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

Jan 1968 Dubcek Becomes Leader → Apr 1968 Prague Spring Action Pro... → 20 Aug 1968 Warsaw Pact Invades Cze... → Sep 1968 Brezhnev Doctrine Procla... → Apr 1969 Husak Begins Normalisati...

Q1 In June 1963, what direct communication link was established between the White House and the Kremlin? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 In August 1963, what international treaty banned nuclear weapons testing in the atmosphere, underwater, and outer space? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 In 1968, which landmark treaty prevented non-nuclear nations from acquiring nuclear weapons technology? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 In January 1968, who replaced hardline Antonin Novotny as First Secretary of the Czechoslovak Communist Party? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 What famous slogan did Alexander Dubcek use to describe his liberal reform program in spring 1968? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 What democratic reforms were introduced during the "Prague Spring" in Czechoslovakia between April and August 1968? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 On 20 August 1968, what military invasion crushed the Prague Spring? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 How did Czechoslovak citizens resist the 1968 Warsaw Pact invasion without engaging in armed violence? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Confusing the Brezhnev Doctrine with the Truman Doctrine. The Truman Doctrine (1947) was US containment of communism; the Brezhnev Doctrine (1968) asserted Soviet right to invade any communist state deviating from Moscow's control.

KT 3.1: The Era of Détente: SALT 1 & Helsinki Accords (1969–1975)

Key Enquiry Question: "Why did the Soviet Union invade Czechoslovakia in 1968 and what was the Brezhnev Doctrine?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE | May 1972 SALT 1 Treaty Signed → Jul 1975 Apollo-Soyuz Space Han... → Aug 1975 Helsinki Accords Signed → Jun 1979 SALT 2 Signed in Vienna → Dec 1979 NATO Pershing II Decision

Q1 What French diplomatic term described the period of easing geopolitical tensions between superpowers in the 1970s? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 What economic pressure motivated the Soviet Union to pursue détente with the USA in the late 1960s? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 What geopolitical development in 1972 convinced Brezhnev that he must build better relations with Washington? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 In May 1972, what historic arms limitation treaty was signed in Moscow by Nixon and Brezhnev? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 Under the 1972 ABM Treaty, how many Anti-Ballistic Missile sites was each superpower permitted to construct? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 In July 1975, which joint space mission symbolized the high point of superpower cooperation during détente? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 In August 1975, which international conference was signed by 35 nations, establishing post-war security and cooperation? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 What was the major Soviet victory contained in "Basket 1" of the 1975 Helsinki Accords? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Overlooking the three distinct "Baskets" of the 1975 Helsinki Accords. Basket 1 recognized post-1945 European borders; Basket 2 expanded trade; Basket 3 bound the USSR to respect human rights, which dissidents used to challenge Soviet tyranny.

KT 3.2: The Breakdown of Détente & Invasion of Afghanistan (1979–1980)

Key Enquiry Question: "To what extent did Détente and the SALT agreements reduce Cold War tensions between 1969 and 1979?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

25 Dec 1979 Soviet Invasion of Afghan... → Jan 1980 Carter Doctrine Announced → Jul 1980 US Boycotts Moscow Oly... → Jan 1981 Reagan Takes Presidentia... → Mar 1983 Reagan Launches SDI (St...

Q1 On 24 December 1979, which non-aligned nation did the Soviet Union invade, bringing a decisive end to détente? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 Which Afghan leader was assassinated during the initial Soviet paratrooper assault on the presidential palace in Kabul? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 What guerrilla resistance fighters launched a holy war (jihad) against the Soviet occupying army in Afghanistan? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 What foreign policy doctrine was declared by President Jimmy Carter in his State of the Union address in January 1980? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 What economic sanctions did the United States impose on the Soviet Union following the invasion of Afghanistan? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 Which major international sporting event in summer 1980 was boycotted by the USA and 65 other nations? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 How did the Soviet Union and 14 Eastern bloc nations retaliate four years later at the 1984 Summer Olympics? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 Which shoulder-fired anti-aircraft missile supplied by the CIA from 1986 turned the tide of the Afghan war for the Mujahideen? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Believing détente ended with Ronald Reagan. Détente was already destroyed in December 1979 under President Jimmy Carter when the Soviet Red Army invaded Afghanistan, prompting the Carter Doctrine and Olympic boycotts.

KT 3.3: The "Second Cold War" & Ronald Reagan (1981–1985)

Key Enquiry Question: "Why did the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan in 1979 trigger the 'Second Cold War'?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

Mar 1985 Gorbachev General Secre... → Nov 1985 Geneva Summit → Oct 1986 Reykjavik Summit → Dec 1987 INF Treaty Scraps Missiles → Dec 1988 Gorbachev Cuts Troops a...

Q1 In March 1983, what famous theological phrase did President Ronald Reagan use to describe the Soviet Union? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 How much did Ronald Reagan increase American defense spending by between 1981 and 1985? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 In March 1983, what ambitious space-based anti-ballistic missile defense system did Reagan propose? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 Why did the Strategic Defence Initiative directly violate the 1972 SALT 1 ABM Treaty? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 Why was Soviet leader Yuri Andropov terrified by the announcement of SDI? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 In September 1983, which civilian airliner was shot down by a Soviet fighter jet after straying into Soviet airspace? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 In November 1983, what NATO military exercise convinced paranoid Soviet leaders that a real nuclear attack was imminent? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 What fundamental structural weakness plagued the Soviet planned economy by the early 1980s? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Believing SDI was actually built. The Strategic Defence Initiative was a theoretical, research-stage laser shield; however, the mere prospect of America building it terrified Soviet leaders because their bankrupt economy could never compete.

KT 3.4: Gorbachev, Fall of the Wall & Collapse of the USSR (1985–1991)

Key Enquiry Question: "How did Reagan's SDI, Gorbachev's reforms, and the 1989 revolutions bring about the collapse of the Soviet Union?"

CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

Jun 1989 Solidarity Wins in Poland → 9 Nov 1989 Berlin Wall Falls → Dec 1989 Malta Summit Ends Cold ... → Oct 1990 German Reunification → 25 Dec 1991 Gorbachev Resigns; USS...

Q1 In March 1985, who became the General Secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union at age 54? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q2 What Russian word did Gorbachev use for his policy of political openness and relaxation of press censorship? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q3 What Russian word described Gorbachev's policy of economic restructuring and introducing private enterprise? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q4 In December 1987, what historic arms reduction treaty was signed in Washington by Reagan and Gorbachev? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q5 What did Gorbachev officially declare regarding the Brezhnev Doctrine in December 1988 at the United Nations? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q6 In June 1989, which non-communist trade union won a landslide victory in semi-free elections in Poland? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q7 On what historic night did East German authorities mistakenly open crossing points, leading citizens to tear down the Berlin Wall? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

Q8 In December 1989, at which summit did George H.W. Bush and Mikhail Gorbachev officially declare the Cold War was over? / 2m

CORE FACT:

EXPLANATION:

⚠ **EXAMINER WARNING & FATAL PITFALL**

Fatal Examiner Trap: Believing Gorbachev set out to destroy communism. His goal was to rescue and revitalize Soviet socialism through openness and restructuring; however, abandoning the Brezhnev Doctrine unleashed unstoppable democratic revolutions.

Q1 USA (Roosevelt/Truman), USSR (Stalin), and Britain (Churchill/Attlee)

Formed as a marriage of convenience to defeat Nazi Germany despite profound ideological hostility.

Q2 To open a "Second Front" in Western Europe (Operation Overlord)

Relieved German military pressure on the Soviet Red Army fighting on the Eastern Front.

Q3 Four occupational zones (US, British, French, and Soviet)

Berlin, located deep inside the Soviet zone, was also subdivided into four corresponding sectors.

Q4 The United Nations (UN)

The USA, USSR, Britain, France, and China received permanent veto power on the Security Council.

Q5 To allow free, democratic elections across Eastern Europe (Declaration on Liberated Europe)

Stalin subsequently broke this pledge, installing puppet communist regimes across Eastern Europe.

Q6 Harry S. Truman

Adopted a far more aggressive, suspicious, and confrontational stance towards Stalin than Roosevelt.

Q7 The successful testing of the atomic bomb (Trinity test in New Mexico)

Intended to intimidate Stalin, but instead accelerated the Soviet crash programme to build their own bomb.

Q8 Each power took reparations primarily from its own occupation zone (USSR got 10% industrial equipment from West)

Prevented a unified German economic policy and deepened the divide between East and West.

Q9 Hiroshima (6 August) and Nagasaki (9 August 1945)

Killed over 120,000 civilians immediately, forced Japan's surrender, and initiated the nuclear arms race.

Q10 The Long Telegram

Warned that the USSR was fanatically hostile to the West and recommended a long-term policy of containment.

Q11 The Novikov Telegram (Nikolai Novikov)

Convinced Stalin that America was building up its military to launch an aggressive war against the USSR.

Q12 An "Iron Curtain" has descended across the continent

Stalin condemned the speech as warmongering and compared Churchill's rhetoric to Adolf Hitler.

Q13 Satellite states (buffer zone)

Created by Stalin across Poland, Hungary, Romania, Bulgaria, and Czechoslovakia to protect Russia from Western invasion.

Q14 "Salami tactics" (cutting away opposition slice by slice)

Coined by Hungarian leader Rakosi to describe gradually arresting, discrediting, and executing rival politicians.

Q15 Czechoslovakia

Foreign Minister Jan Masaryk was defenestrated (thrown from a window), shocking the US Congress into passing Marshall Aid.

Q16 Poland had served as the historical military corridor for German invasions of Russia in 1914 and 1941

Cost the Soviet Union 27 million lives during WWII, convincing Stalin that a friendly Polish buffer was non-negotiable.

Q17 The Truman Doctrine

Pledged American economic and military assistance to any nation resisting armed subjugation by communist minorities.

Q18 Greece and Turkey

Britain could no longer afford to support the Greek monarchy against communist guerrillas, prompting US intervention.

Q19 Containment

Aimed to halt the outward geographic expansion of Soviet communism rather than rolling back existing territory.

Q20 The Marshall Plan (European Recovery Program)

Provided $13.7 billion in grants and goods over four years to reconstruct Western European economies and trade.

Q21 Creating prosperous export markets for American industrial and agricultural goods

Prevented the US economy from sliding into a post-war depression by financing European purchases of US products.

Q22 "Dollar Imperialism" (economic enslavement of Europe)

Stalin claimed the US was using financial aid to establish an economic empire and undermine European sovereignty.

Q23 Cominform (Communist Information Bureau)

Enforced ideological conformity to Moscow across Eastern Europe and ensured member states rejected Marshall Aid.

Q24 Comecon (Council for Mutual Economic Assistance)

Organised bilateral trade agreements and national specialisation within the Soviet bloc, excluding Western trade.

Q25 The British and American zones (later Trizonia with France)

Created a unified economic territory in Western Germany, provoking fierce Soviet protests at four-power talks.

Q26 The introduction of a new Western currency, the Deutschmark

Stalin feared the Deutschmark would undermine the worthless Soviet East German currency and unify the West.

Q27 Imposed a total ground blockade on all road, rail, and canal routes into West Berlin

Cut electricity, food, and fuel to 2 million West Berliners deep inside the Soviet occupation zone.

Q28 The Berlin Airlift (Operation Vittles)

US and British transport planes flew supplies into Tempelhof and Gatow airports every three minutes around the clock.

Q29 Eleven months (June 1948 to May 1949)

Delivered 2.3 million tonnes of supplies, proving Western determination to defend freedom in Berlin.

Q30 The Federal Republic of Germany (FRG / West Germany)

Led by democratic Chancellor Konrad Adenauer with its capital at Bonn.

Q31 The German Democratic Republic (GDR / East Germany)

A communist one-party state governed by the SED under Walter Ulbricht.

Q32 NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organisation)

Article 5 declared that an armed attack against one member in Europe or North America would be considered an attack on all.

Q33 The Soviet Union successfully tested its first atomic bomb (RDS-1)

Shocked Washington years ahead of CIA predictions and dramatically escalated the Cold War arms race.

Q34 The Hydrogen Bomb (thermonuclear bomb / Ivy Mike)

The Soviet Union matched the US by testing its own deployable hydrogen bomb in August 1953.

Q35 ICBMs (Intercontinental Ballistic Missiles)

Eliminated reliance on slow bombers; the USSR demonstrated leadership with the Sputnik launch in October 1957.

Q36 The "Secret Speech" to the 20th Party Congress

Denounced Stalin's crimes, purges, and personality cult, raising false hopes of political reform in satellite states.

Q37 Matyas Rakosi ("the bald butcher")

His secret police (AVH) terrorised Hungary, creating simmering public fury that exploded into street protests in October.

Q38 Imre Nagy

A moderate communist reformer who introduced free elections, abolished the secret police, and freed political prisoners.

Q39 Hungary's withdrawal from the Warsaw Pact and declaration of national neutrality

Stalin and Khrushchev could not tolerate a gaping hole in their military buffer zone bordering Austria.

Q40 1,000 Soviet tanks and 200,000 troops

Crushed armed Hungarian street resistance, killing over 20,000 Hungarians and forcing 200,000 to flee into exile.

Q41 Around 2.7 million to 3 million people (one-sixth of the GDR population)

Created an existential economic crisis for East Germany because the majority were young, skilled professionals ("brain drain").

Q42 The Berlin Ultimatum (demanding Western troops leave Berlin within 6 months to make it a free city)

Khrushchev threatened to hand control of access routes to East Germany if the West refused to withdraw.

Q43 The Camp David Summit

Khrushchev withdrew his six-month ultimatum, and the leaders agreed to hold a full superpower summit in Paris in 1960.

Q44 The shooting down of an American U-2 spy plane over Soviet airspace

Pilot Gary Powers was captured alive; Eisenhower refused to apologise, causing Khrushchev to storm out of Paris.

Q45 He bullied Kennedy by reissuing the Berlin Ultimatum, believing JFK was young and inexperienced

Kennedy refused to back down, increasing US defense spending by $3.2 billion and expanding military draft calls.

Q46 Sunday, 13 August 1961 (Operation Rose)

Closed all crossing points overnight, separating families and beginning construction of the concrete Berlin Wall.

Q47 The Standoff at Checkpoint Charlie

US diplomat E. Allan Lightner was stopped from entering East Berlin; after 16 hours Kennedy and Khrushchev agreed to pull tanks back.

Q48 "Ich bin ein Berliner" ("I am a Berliner")

Affirmed unwavering American commitment to West Berlin and condemned the Wall as the ultimate symbol of communist failure.

Q49 Fidel Castro

Nationalised American-owned sugar plantations, banks, and oil refineries, prompting the US to impose a trade embargo.

Q50 The Soviet Union (Nikita Khrushchev)

Turned Cuba into a communist ally barely 90 miles off the coast of Florida.

Q51 The Bay of Pigs Invasion (La Playa Giron)

Failed within 72 hours when Kennedy canceled US air cover; humiliated America and pushed Castro directly into Soviet arms.

Q52 To protect Cuba from another US invasion and balance US Jupiter missiles stationed in neighbouring Turkey

Also aimed to close the "missile gap" and gain immense leverage over Berlin negotiations.

Q53 Photographs of Soviet medium-range ballistic missile (MRBM) launch pads under construction in Cuba

Initiated the "Thirteen Days" (16–28 October 1962) where the world came closest to full thermonuclear war.

Q54 ExComm (Executive Committee of the National Security Council)

Debated military airstrikes and invasion against a naval quarantine, with Kennedy choosing the middle option.

Q55 Under international law, a "blockade" is a formal act of war; a "quarantine" was framed as a defensive measure

Gave Khrushchev time to turn his ships around without immediately triggering combat.

Q56 A US U-2 spy plane piloted by Major Rudolf Anderson was shot down over Cuba by a Soviet SAM missile

US military chiefs demanded immediate retaliatory airstrikes, but Kennedy refused to authorize them.

Q57 The Moscow-Washington Hotline (Teletype / wire link)

Allowed superpower leaders to communicate instantly during crises to prevent accidental nuclear escalation.

Q58 The Limited Test Ban Treaty (LTBT)

Permitted only underground testing; marked the first formal multilateral treaty limiting nuclear weaponry.

Q59 The Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT)

Nuclear states pledged not to transfer weapons, while non-nuclear signatories agreed to peaceful civilian nuclear power only.

Q60 Alexander Dubcek

Committed to reforming the communist system from within while remaining a loyal member of the Warsaw Pact.

Q61 "Socialism with a human face"

Aimed to combine communist planned economy with democratic freedoms, ending censorship and allowing rival parties.

Q62 Abolition of press censorship, freedom of speech, legalization of trade unions, and permission to travel to the West

Terrified Soviet leader Leonid Brezhnev and neighbouring communist rulers like Ulbricht in East Germany.

Q63 500,000 Warsaw Pact troops and 2,000 tanks invaded Czechoslovakia

Seized radio stations, arrested Dubcek, and took him in handcuffs to Moscow to sign away his reforms.

Q64 Non-violent civil disobedience (standing in front of tanks, painting over street signs, and student Jan Palach self-immolation)

Prevented the heavy bloodshed of Hungary 1956, but left the country demoralised under Soviet military occupation.

Q65 Détente (relaxation of tension)
Pursued by President Richard Nixon, Henry Kissinger, and Soviet Premier Leonid Brezhnev to reduce the cost of the arms race.

Q66 Crippling military expenditure and declining living standards (the Soviet economy was stagnant)
The USSR was spending up to 20% of its GDP on weapons, causing chronic food shortages and desperate need for US grain.

Q67 President Nixon's historic visit to communist China (triangular diplomacy)
The USSR feared a hostile US-Chinese alliance against Moscow, compelling Brezhnev to invite Nixon to Moscow.

Q68 SALT 1 (Strategic Arms Limitation Talks)
Consisted of the Anti-Ballistic Missile (ABM) Treaty and an Interim Agreement freezing missile launcher numbers.

Q69 Two ABM sites (each with a maximum of 100 interceptor missiles; reduced to one in 1974)
Preserved "Mutual Assured Destruction" (MAD) by guaranteeing that neither side could build a shield to survive a counter-strike.

Q70 The Apollo-Soyuz Test Project (handshake in space)
US astronaut Thomas Stafford and Soviet cosmonaut Alexei Leonov docked spacecraft in orbit and shook hands.

Q71 The Helsinki Accords (Helsinki Declaration)
Represented the high-water mark of détente, dividing agreements into three thematic "Baskets".

Q72 Recognition of existing European borders (including the division of Germany and Soviet annexation of the Baltic states)
Formally legitimized post-WWII European borders and accepted the Soviet sphere of influence.

Q73 Afghanistan
Stalin and Brezhnev feared an Islamic revolution on their southern border following the 1979 Iranian Revolution.

Q74 Hafizullah Amin
Soviet intelligence believed Amin was secretly negotiating with the CIA; he was replaced by pro-Soviet puppet Babrak Karmal.

Q75 The Mujahideen (holy warriors)
Fought a fierce ten-year insurgency using mountain terrain, receiving covert weapons and cash from the CIA, Pakistan, and Saudi Arabia.

Q76 The Carter Doctrine
Declared that any attempt by an outside power to gain control of the Persian Gulf region would be repelled by US military force.

Q77 Suspension of grain sales to the USSR and restrictions on high-technology exports
Inflicted severe economic pain on the Soviet Union and ended US-Soviet trade cooperation.

Q78 The 1980 Moscow Summer Olympic Games
Organised by President Carter to protest Soviet aggression, leaving the games heavily depleted.

Q79 They boycotted the 1984 Los Angeles Olympic Games
Claimed their athletes would not be safe from anti-communist protesters in California.

Q80 The FIM-92 Stinger missile
Neutralised Soviet helicopter gunships (Mi-24 Hinds), robbing the Red Army of its decisive battlefield air superiority.

Q81 An "Evil Empire" (and the focus of evil in the modern world)
Framed the Cold War not as a conventional balance of power dispute, but as a moral crusade between freedom and totalitarianism.

Q82 US defense spending increased by over 40% (to over $300 billion annually)
Financed massive rearmament, including B-1 bombers, MX Peacekeeper missiles, and a 600-ship US Navy.

Q83 The Strategic Defence Initiative (SDI / nicknamed "Star Wars")
Proposed using laser and satellite technology to intercept and destroy Soviet nuclear missiles in flight before they reached America.

Q84 The 1972 ABM Treaty strictly banned nationwide anti-ballistic missile defenses and space-based weapons
Reagan argued SDI was a purely defensive shield that would render nuclear weapons obsolete.

Q85 If America could block Soviet retaliation, the US could launch a first nuclear strike with absolute impunity
Worse, Soviet scientists calculated that matching US computer and laser technology would bankrupt the USSR.

Q86 Korean Air Lines Flight 007 (KAL 007)
Killed all 269 passengers and crew, including a US Congressman; Reagan condemned it as a "massacre" and barbaric atrocity.

Q87 Exercise Able Archer 83
The USSR placed nuclear-capable air squadrons in East Germany on high alert, bringing superpowers terrifyingly close to war.

Q88 Economic stagnation, chronic shortages of food and basic goods, widespread corruption, and obsolete technology
Spending up to 25% of national wealth on the military left living standards lagging far behind the capitalist West.

Q89 Mikhail Gorbachev
The youngest member of the Politburo, dedicated to reforming Soviet communism through revolutionary "New Thinking".

Q90 Glasnost (openness)
Allowed public debate, free reporting of state corruption and disasters (like Chernobyl 1986), and freedom of speech.

Q91 Perestroika (restructuring)
Allowed small private businesses, foreign investment, and decentralized factory management to stimulate production.

Q92 The INF Treaty (Intermediate-Range Nuclear Forces Treaty)
Eliminated an entire category of nuclear weapons (all ground-launched cruise and ballistic missiles with ranges 500–5,500km).

Q93 The USSR would no longer use military force to intervene in Eastern European internal affairs
Foreign ministry spokesman Gennadi Gerasimov nicknamed this the "Sinatra Doctrine" (they can do it "My Way").

Q94 Solidarity (Solidarnosc), led by Lech Walesa
Gorbachev refused to intervene, and Tadeusz Mazowiecki became Eastern Europe's first non-communist prime minister since 1948.

Q95 Thursday, 9 November 1989
Spokesman Gunter Schabowski accidentally announced immediate travel freedom; millions celebrated as the Wall was dismantled.

Q96 The Malta Summit
Held on cruise ships off Malta; Gorbachev declared the world was leaving an epoch of Cold War and entering peace.